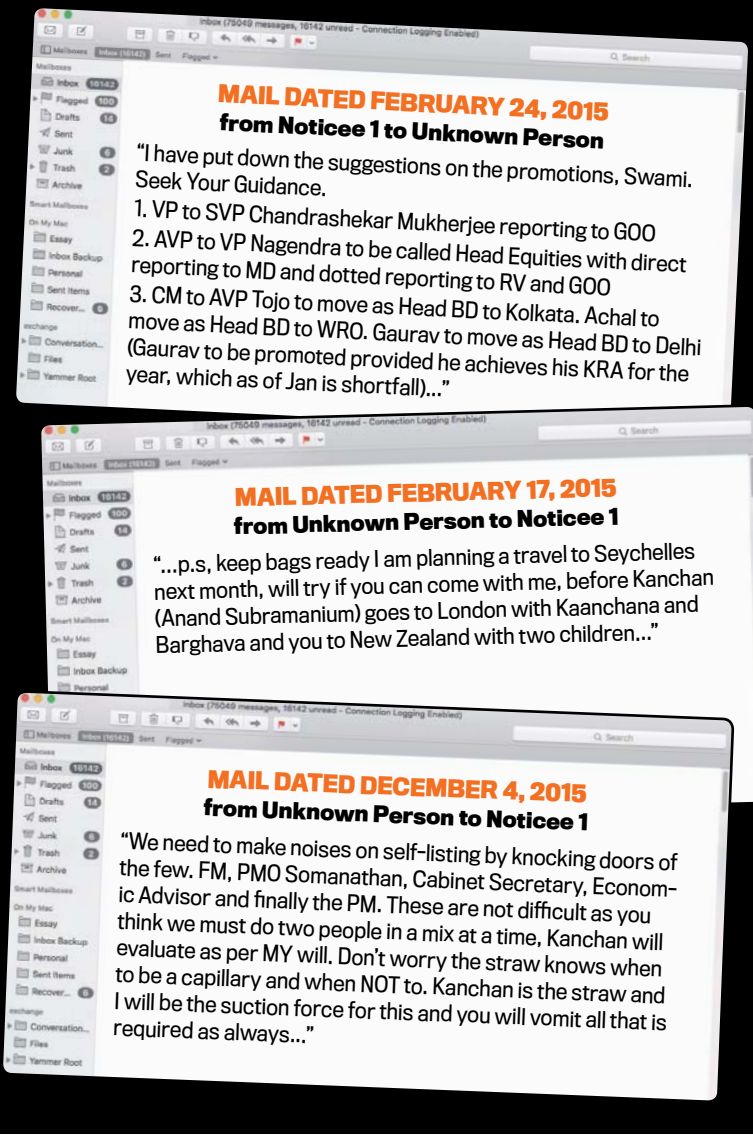
EMAIL EXCHANGES BETWEEN CHITRA RAMKRISHNA AND THE MYSTERY YOGI, AS EXCERPTED FROM THE SEBI ORDER



aspects of the NSE's functioning. In her response to SEBI, Ramkrishna identified the mysterious person as a "Siddha Purusha" or "yogi" dwelling mostly in the Himalayas. On March 11, the CBI told a special court that the email account through which the yogi was communicating with Ramkrishna was created by Anand Subramanian, whom she hired in 2013 as the NSE's chief strategic officer and who was made the group operating officer (GOO) and advisor to the MD and CEO in 2015. The report of a forensics investigation conducted by Ernst & Young (EY) suggests that the yogi is Subramanian.

THE MYSTERY YOGI

Subramanian was arrested by the CBI in February, two weeks after the SEBI order indicting Ramkrishna for hiring him in contravention of the rules. According to SEBI, his previous work experience was not relevant to the post he was offered at the NSE with a more than 10-fold hike in remuneration. His salary nearly doubled every year, and in 2016 he was drawing Rs 4.21 crore per annum. Eyebrows were also raised over his proximity to Ramkrishna—in fact, their cabins had an interconnecting door—as well as his growing clout in the organisation. "There were a lot of complaints that he had become the de facto boss," says a former NSE board member.

In October 2016, following complaints to SEBI over his appointment, the board asked Subramanian to leave. "When the board told Ramkrishna that Subramanian has been sacked with immediate effect, she was rattled," recalls the former board member, adding that the board had been recently reconstituted due to concern over corporate governance at the NSE. The former board member reveals that two months later, they decided to remove Ramkrishna too, but she resigned on the morning of the day the board meeting was scheduled. She was given an easy exit and handed everything that was owed to her at the time of settlement—"to avoid exactly what's happening now," says the former board member.

The EY forensics report, which the NSE board accepted, claims that the Skype accounts with usernames anand.subramanian9 and sironmani.10, which were found on Subramanian's NSE desktop, were configured in the Skype application database and linked to Subramanian's mobile number and the yogi's email ID rigyajursama@outlook.com that Ramkrishna was communicating with. Moreover, Word documents sent from the email ID show Subramanian as the author and the images sent have the geo-tag of his Chennai address. A booking made at Umaid Bhawan Palace, Jodhpur, through the email ID corresponds with Subrama-